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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **SoftBank Group** has agreed to invest \$2 billion in embattled chip maker Intel, a boost from the private sector that coincides with a government rescue effort. **B1**

◆ **MSNBC is changing** its name to MS NOW as part of an effort to establish its own identity ahead of the cable network's spinoff from Comcast's NBCUniversal. **B1**

◆ **Newsmax agreed to pay** \$67 million to Dominion to settle a defamation lawsuit over on-air claims that the voting-machine company helped rig the 2020 U.S. presidential election. **B2**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** entered the doldrums, with the S&P 500 and Dow each losing less than 0.1% and the Nasdaq rising less than 0.1%. **B9**

◆ **Chinese shares rallied**, powering Shanghai's benchmark index to its highest closing level in a decade. **B9**

◆ **Union leaders for Air Canada's** 10,000 flight attendants face fines and criminal charges after defying a second order from Canada's labor board to end a strike. **B1**

◆ **Investors led by one of the country's** biggest hotel owners struck a deal to take members' club operator Soho House private. **B1**

◆ **Shares of Novo Nordisk** rose in European trading after the FDA approved a new indication for the Danish drugmaker's Wegovy medicine to treat a serious fatty-liver disease. **B5**

◆ **Starbucks will give** corporate employees a 2% raise this year, moving away from merit-based increases at a time when the coffee chain is striving to control costs. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump urged** Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and Russian President Vladimir Putin to meet face to face with him at a peace conference in a long-shot bid to end the 3½-year-long war in Ukraine. **A1, A7**

◆ **Trump criticized** mail-in voting, suggesting he would push to alter balloting decisions traditionally left to the states ahead of next year's midterm elections. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** has restored a public website that tracks federal spending, in a victory for lawmakers who complained the White House was using the blackout to freeze funding without public disclosures. **A3**

◆ **An antitrust lawyer** who was dismissed last month from the Justice Department accused senior officials of cutting deals with favored lobbyists and undermining the independence of antitrust enforcement. **A3**

◆ **Texas House Democrats** returned to the state after a two-week walkout, all but ensuring the passage of a Republican-backed redistricting plan that the president has sought. **A4**

◆ **Former Sen. Sherrod Brown** launched a comeback bid in Ohio, bolstering Democrats' long-shot hopes of flipping back the Senate in the 2026 elections. **A4**

◆ **The global economy** appears to have taken a sharp rise in U.S. tariffs and increased uncertainty about the future of the international trading system in stride, but faces stronger headwinds as tax rates climb. **A16**

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U.S. Urges Zelensky, Putin to Meet



KEVIN LAJARQUE/REUTERS

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky received a warmer welcome Monday from President Trump than on his previous visit.

Trump's gambit comes as he meets Ukrainian president, European leaders

WASHINGTON—President Trump on Monday urged Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and Russian President Vladimir Putin to meet face to face with him at a peace conference in a long-shot U.S.-led bid to end the 3½-year-long war in Ukraine.

By Michael R. Gordon,
Bojan Pancevski
and Annie Linskey

Zelensky quickly embraced the idea of a three-way summit. But after speaking with Putin, Trump said in a social-media post that Zelensky and Putin would have to hold one-on-one talks first. Only then might a meeting among the three leaders take place.

In a sign that the rapid developments may have left even participants confused, Mark Rutte, secretary-general of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, said in an interview on Fox News that Putin had in fact agreed to meet with Zelensky. *Please turn to page A7*

◆ **Russia launches deadly attack on Kharkiv**..... **A7**

JPMorgan's \$3 Billion Bet Shows NYC Office Revival

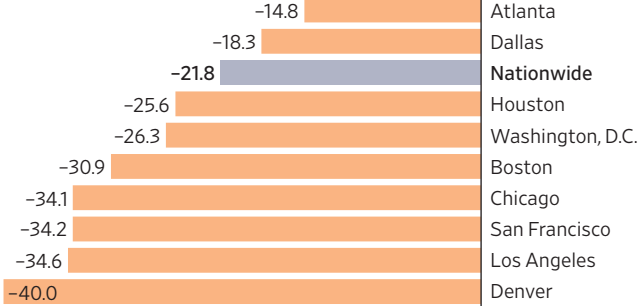
By REBECCA PICCIOTTO

The New York City office market is recovering from its pandemic debacle faster than any other in the U.S. Nothing speaks more to the turnaround than the gleaming new office tower built for JPMorgan Chase.

After more than six years of development, the bank is preparing to move thousands of employees into its new, 2.5-million-square-foot headquarters at 270 Park Ave. later this month before its October grand opening. The 60-story building is a roughly \$3 billion bet that New York is definitively back after years of uncertainty about whether it would maintain its leadership in business and finance.

"It's a very big deal," said the New York power broker Kathryn Wyld, head of the Partnership for New York City, a business group. "It's a statement about the future of New York City."

Office visits in July 2025, change from the same month in 2019



Source: Placer.ai

York City."

As the city rallies, the rest of the country is slowly clawing its way back. New York City office visits, or foot traffic, exceeded 2019 levels for the first time in July, according to Placer.ai, a location-analytics firm. It was the only major city to hit that milestone. Office visits nationally were down 22% in July compared with the same month in

2019, the firm found.

The city's office rebound is driven by business executives who are looking to put the days of remote work behind them.

To lure employees back to the workplace, more companies are chasing the high-end buildings that Manhattan is known for. Some 2 million square feet of New York City's trophy office space has been *Please turn to page A2*

Trump Seeks End Of Mail-In Voting

By JOHN MCCORMICK
AND VICTORIA ALBERT

President Trump's back-and-forth relationship with mail-in voting has taken its latest turn, with the Republican again lambasting the practice and suggesting he will push to alter balloting decisions traditionally left up to states ahead of next year's midterm elections.

"I am going to lead a movement to get rid of MAIL-IN BALLOTS," Trump posted on his social-media platform Monday. "The States are merely an 'agent' for the Federal Government in counting and tabulating the votes. They must do what the Federal Government, as represented by the President of the United States, tells them."

Trump pledged to sign an executive order to "help bring HONESTY to the 2026 Midterm Elections."

It is his latest move to try to place his imprint on next year's

balloting, elections that traditionally favor the party that doesn't hold the White House. In March, Trump signed an executive order that aims to reshape how elections are carried out in the U.S. by setting new identification requirements for voter registration and prohibiting the counting of absentee or mail-in ballots received after Election Day.

Trump is also pushing Texas and other Republican-led states to change their congressional district lines to help gain GOP seats and protect against Democrats taking control of the U.S. House. Republicans hold a slim 219 to 212 majority and a GOP loss of complete control of Washington would severely curtail his administration's ability to move legislation.

California and other Democratic-led states have pledged *Please turn to page A4*

◆ **Texas lawmakers return after walkout**..... **A4**

INSIDE



HARRY HOW/GETTY IMAGES

SPORTS

Teams are hatching ingenious ways to take advantage of new NFL rules for kickoffs. **A12**



QULAI SHEN FOR WSJ

BUSINESS & FINANCE

How Crocs conquered China after stumbling there for the better part of a decade. **B1**

How a Modest Income Supports a Big Family

By TE-PING CHEN

Brittany Ivy didn't have much money in the bank. She and her new husband, Michael Ivy, had just paid for their wedding, and they had less than \$1,000 in savings left.

But they also hoped for a big family, and wanted to get started. Sure, Brittany was making \$10 an hour at a retail job at

Home Depot. But Michael's union construction job paid more than triple that, and he'd owned his own home, a modest two-bedroom outside Cincinnati, for more than a decade.

So the two took the plunge, and in 2012 they welcomed their first baby. Brittany was 20; her husband, 34. The birth was difficult. Her son's umbilical cord was wrapped around

his head, and he had to be extracted from her birth canal, fracturing her pelvis. Still, she was smitten. "Your heart grows three sizes," she recalls. "I couldn't stop looking at him."

The Ivys now have five children, ages 3 to 12. They know they aren't the norm.

More Americans than ever are putting off having children—or not having them at

all. The U.S. total fertility rate is around an all-time low, and far below the rate needed to keep the population stable. The average age of women giving birth in the U.S. has risen to nearly 30 years old, up from 27 years old in 2000, according to government data.

Those trends have become a flashpoint in American life to *Please turn to page A10*

An 11-Year-Old Boy on a Boat Stirs Pride and Envy in Indonesia

A 20-second dance made him a global star, to the dismay of his more talented rivals

By STU WOO

AND TONGGO SIMANGUNSONG

KUANTAN SINGINGI, Indonesia—The video made Rayyan Arkan Dikha the world's coolest kid.

At 11, he went viral for dancing in futuristic sunglasses while balancing on a skinny boat going 20 miles an hour during a race. His job was to hype up his rowers, and he did it so suavely that Travis Kelce and other celebrities around the world paid tribute.

As the annual boat competition returns this week, vil-

lagers in this rural Indonesian region are celebrating his fame and the financial windfall that followed.

They're also asking: Why him?

Dikha's team is no title contender. It didn't even win that viral race. And many of the 200 other boys who dance on racing boats have more talent.

"Dikha got lucky," said Aprilastuti, who, like many Indonesians, uses only one name. She points instead to the highly regarded dancer for the reigning champs: Arkha, her 10-year-old son. *Please turn to page A8*

A New Reality for Terminal Cancer

Patients are living longer; unending treatment casts a shadow

By BRIANNA ABBOTT

Gwen Orilio didn't know how long she had to live after her stage-four lung cancer diagnosis. The disease had already infiltrated her eye, so the 31-year-old didn't bother opening a retirement account.

Ten years later, Orilio is still alive. And she still has metastatic cancer.

Keeping her going is a string of new treatments that don't cure the disease

but can buy months—even years—of time, with the hope that once one drug stops working a new one will come along. Orilio started on chemotherapy, and then switched to a new treatment, and then another, and another, and another.

"What's next? What do I have lined up for when this one stops working?" said Orilio, a high-school math teacher who lives in Garner, *Please turn to page A8*